

🔪 Red Pen for WordPress

User manual - review notes pinned to the pages and elements of your WordPress site.

Version 0.25.4 · July 2026 · by Lincoln Tracy · redpen.tools

What Red Pen does

While you look at your site, you leave typed notes on the things they're about: "swap this header photo" pinned to the image, "should this button scroll instead?" pinned to the button. Notes live in a panel on the front end, show as numbered pins on the page, and collect in one repository in wp-admin. Clients can leave feedback through a private link with no WordPress login, and the whole pile prints to a clean report.

Everything stays in your WordPress database. No accounts, no external service, nothing leaves your site.

Install and activate

Plugins > Add New > Upload Plugin, choose the Red Pen zip, activate. That's it - one self-contained plugin file, no configuration required. You'll find the repository under **Tools > Red Pen** and a new entry in the admin bar.

Dev Mode

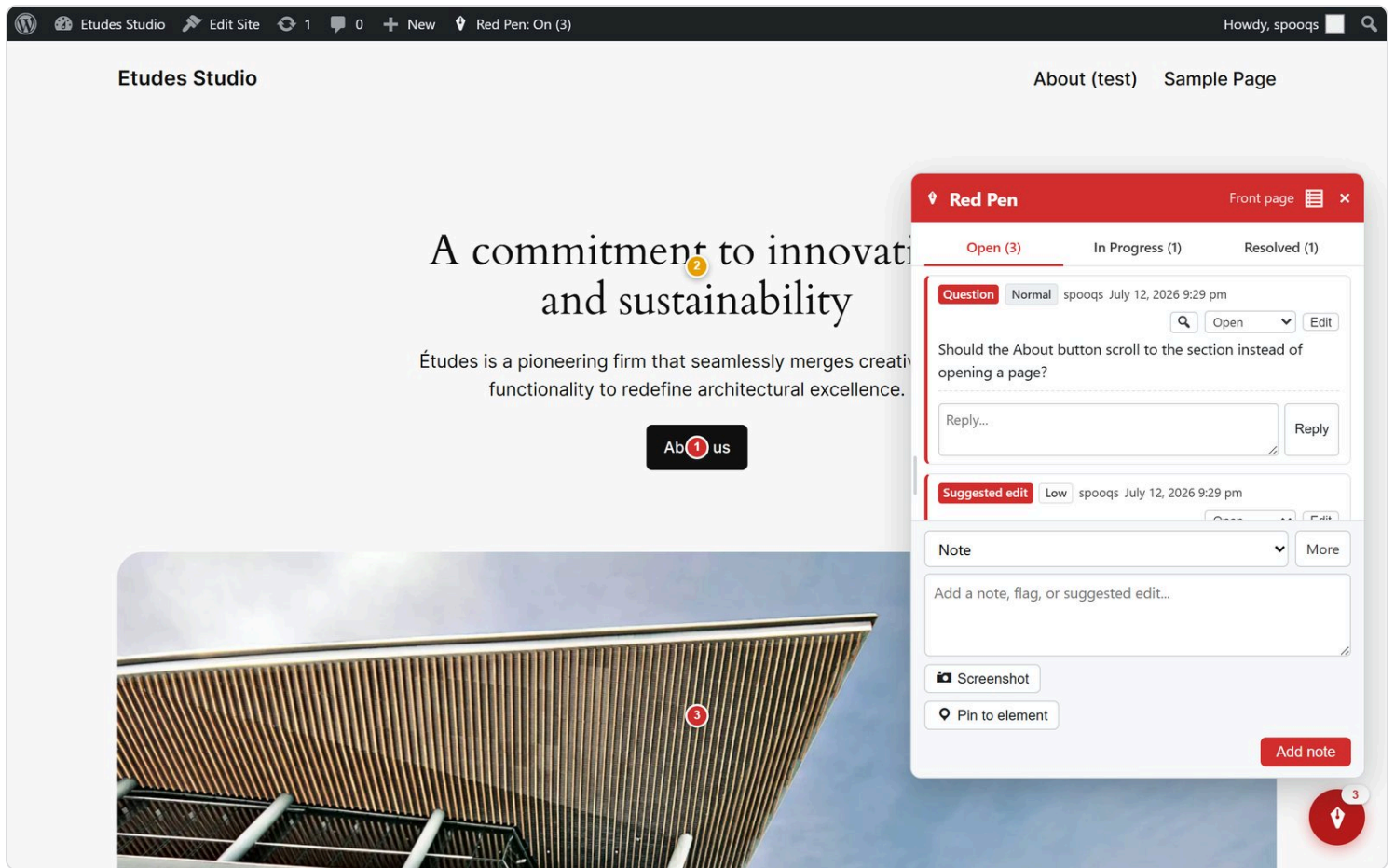
Red Pen stays invisible until you switch it on. The admin bar gets a **Red Pen: On/Off** entry with the count of open notes - click it to toggle. Dev Mode is per-user: your editors see the overlay only when they've turned it on, and visitors never see anything.



The admin-bar toggle, with the open-note count. Its submenu jumps to the repository, and "J" jumps to the next open note on the page.

Leaving a note

With Dev Mode on, a red pen button sits in the corner of every page. Click it and the panel opens: pick a type (Note, Idea, Problem, Question - or your own custom types), write the note, add it. **Pin to element** lets you click the exact thing on the page the note is about - it becomes a numbered pin. **Screenshot** captures the page state alongside the note.



The panel over a page. Numbered pins mark element-anchored notes; the tabs split Open, In Progress, and Resolved.

The **More** drawer holds the rest: priority, severity, an assignee (a teammate - or an AI agent queue, if enabled), and the reporting level, which controls whether the note belongs to this page, this template, or the whole site.

Red Pen

Front page

Open (3)

In Progress (1)

Resolved (1)

Question

Normal

spooqs July 12, 2026 9:29 pm

Q

Open

Edit

Should the About button scroll to the section instead of

Note

More

Normal

Severity...

Unassigned

Reporting level

Front page

Nav overlaps the logo below 700 px

Screenshot

Pin to element

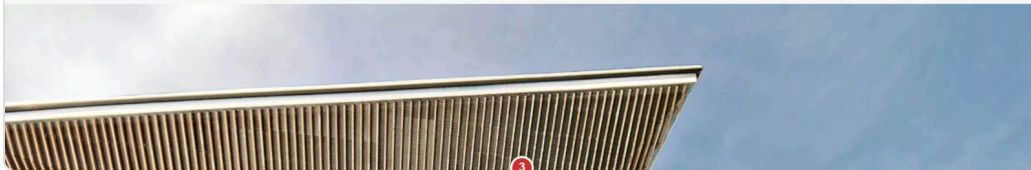
Add note

The More drawer: priority, severity, assignee, reporting level, screenshot and pin.

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Ab1 us



Pins land on the elements the notes are about.

Statuses, priorities, and replies

Every note is **Open**, **In Progress**, or **Resolved** - the panel's three tabs. Each note carries a priority, an optional severity, and its own reply thread, so the back-and-forth about a note stays on the note.

The repository

Tools > Red Pen lists every note across the site: filter by status, assignee, or source (client reviews vs dev notes), change priority or assignment inline, resolve or delete, use bulk actions, or export the lot to CSV. The three panels above the list hold Display settings, the Client report, and Client review links.

WordPress Etudes Studio 2 Ctrl+K 0 New Red Pen: On (3) Howdy, spooqs

Dashboard

Posts

Media

Pages

Comments

Appearance

Plugins

Users

Tools

Available Tools

Import

Export

Site Health 1

Export Personal Data

Erase Personal Data

Red Pen

Theme File Editor

Plugin File Editor

Settings

Collapse Menu

WordPress 7.0.1 is available! [Please update now.](#)

Red Pen - Notes Repository

Every note, flag, and suggested edit dropped across the site. Shared with all editors and admins.

Display settings

Client report

Client review links

Open | In Progress | Resolved | All

All assignees | Assigned to me | Unassigned

Source: All sources | Client reviews | Dev notes

Export CSV

Bulk actions ▼ Apply

☐	Type	Priority	Note	Where	Assigned	By	When	
☐	Question	Normal ▼	Should the About button scroll to the section instead of opening a page?	Front page ↗ Page	Unassigned ▼	spooqs	July 12, 2026	Open Start Resolve Edit Delete
			📌 Pinned to an element					
☐	Suggested edit	Low ▼	Try the serif face for pull quotes too - it would tie the	Front page ↗ Page	Unassigned ▼	spooqs	July 12, 2026	Open Start Resolve

The notes repository under Tools, with filters, bulk actions and CSV export.

Client review links

Generate a private link and your client can leave notes on the live site with **no WordPress login**. The link is shown once at creation - the token is stored hashed, like a password - and Revoke kills it instantly. Links can expire on a schedule or live until revoked.

► Client report

▼ Client review links

Generate a private link that lets a client leave feedback notes on the front end without a WordPress login. Share it only with people you trust. The link is shown once at creation (the token is stored hashed, like a password) - if you lose it, revoke the link and make a new one. Revoke is the kill switch: it stops the link working immediately.

New review link for "Manual demo link"

Copy this now - it will not be shown again.

```
http://localhost/library/Claude%20Code%20Projects/wpmm-test-1/?wprp_review=c1e471622064c
```

Label (client or project name)

Acme Co - new site review

Expiry

Never (revoke manually) ▼

Generate link

Label	Created	Expires	Status	Action
Manual demo link	July 12, 2026	Never	Active	Revoke
Manual demo link	July 12, 2026	Never	Active	Revoke

Generating a review link. Copy it at creation - it is not shown again.

A link holder gets a deliberately narrow version of the panel: they can read open notes, write notes, pin, and reply - and nothing else. No resolving, no admin access, no screenshots, no user lists. The boundary is enforced on the server, and reviewer submissions are rate-limited.

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functionality to redefine architectural excellence.

About ¹ us



Red Pen Front page x

Open (3) In Progress (0) Resolved (0)

Question Normal Reviewer July 12, 2026 9:29 pm

Should the About button scroll to the section instead of opening a page?

Reply... Reply

Suggested edit Low Reviewer July 12, 2026 9:29 pm

Try the serif face for pull quotes too - it would tie the sections together

Note More

Add a note, flag, or suggested edit...

Pin to element

Add note

What the client sees through a review link: notes and pins, none of the controls.

The client report

One click in the repository turns the notes into a printable report - totals, then every note grouped by status, ready for "Print / Save as PDF". Internal fields (assignees, agent queues, browser context) stay out; the report is written for the client's eyes.

Print / Save as PDF
Show open items only

Etudes Studio - Review Report

Etudes Studio · <http://localhost/library/Claude%20Code%20Projects/wpmm-test-1> · July 12, 2026 9:29 pm

5
TOTAL

3
OPEN

1
IN PROGRESS

1
RESOLVED

Open (3)

Note Open

On: Front page

Swap the header photo for the golden-hour take from the reshoot

Added July 12, 2026 9:29 pm

Question Open

On: Front page

Should the About button scroll to the section instead of opening a page?

Added July 12, 2026 9:29 pm

Suggested edit Open

On: Front page

Try the serif face for pull quotes too - it would tie the sections together

Added July 12, 2026 9:29 pm

The client report. The report settings let you set your own title, logo and accent colour and hide the Red Pen credit - white-label branding is free for everyone.

Red Pen Hub (optional)

If you run several projects, the free Red Pen Hub collects their notes onto one local board. Connect this site from Display settings in the repository: paste the Hub's URL and connect token, and the site pushes its notes to your Hub - resolving on either side updates the other. The Hub, like Red Pen itself, is free. Ignore this section if you work one site at a time; nothing requires it.

Where your notes live

Notes are a private post type inside your own WordPress database, invisible to the front end and to search engines. Screenshots go to your uploads folder. Deactivating the plugin hides the overlay; your notes stay in the database until you delete them.

If something breaks

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
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No Red Pen entry in the admin bar	Your user can't edit posts (Red Pen shows for editors and up), or the plugin isn't active on this site.
Overlay missing on a page	Dev Mode is off (check the admin-bar toggle), or that view is excluded under Display settings.
A pin doesn't show	The element it was pinned to no longer exists on the page - the note itself is still in the panel and repository.
Client says the review link doesn't work	The link was revoked or expired, or it was mistyped - the full token is part of the URL. Generate a fresh one.

Red Pen for WordPress 0.25.4 - built by Lincoln Tracy. Part of the Red Pen family: WordPress, Express, static sites, Blender, Ableton Live, and the Red Pen Hub. redpen.tools